

98 To The Rescue

Q I have Windows XP Pro installed. Recently, I've started getting the error message "NTLDR not found" during bootup, and I'm not able to boot into Windows. I don't want to lose my programs and data. Please help.

Santosh Rane

A If you have FAT32 on your boot drive, that is, the drive on which Windows resides, just boot with a Windows 98 bootable floppy. Select the "Boot with CDROM support" option. Insert your Windows XP CD into the drive. Copy the NTLDR and NTDETECT.COM files from the i386 folder of the

CD to the root of the boot drive.

If your boot drive has been formatted with NTFS, then first boot with the Windows XP CD. At the first "R=Repair" option, press [R] key. Press the number that corresponds to the correct location of the boot drive. If Windows is installed on the C: drive, then this number is 1. Enter the Administrator password when prompted to do so. Enter the following commands:
COPY X:\i386\NTLDR C:\
COPY X:\i386\NTDETECT.COM C:\
Replace "X" with your CD-ROM's drive letter. Eject the CD-ROM and type in "exit". You should no longer face the problem you described.

At Sixes And Sevens

Q I have an original Nero Burning ROM 6 CD, which I got free with my writer. My problem is, I cannot update my Nero 6 original with the Nero 7 you gave out on your CD/DVD.

Dilip Wakil

A You can only upgrade for free when there's a minor version upgrade. To upgrade to a major new version, you need to purchase that version of Nero. You can upgrade to Nero 7 at a discount (you have Nero 6) from http://www.nero.com/enu/Upgrade_InfoPage.php.

Reliance Unreliable?

Q I use RConnect (Reliance) for connecting to the Internet. I've started facing a strange problem. Whenever I try to connect, RConnect says "error720:PPP control protocol not configured." What does this mean?

Akshit Gaur

A The RAS (Remote Access Services) Server to which you are dialling does not have the TCP/IP protocol installed or configured for RAS. (Remote Access Services lets you connect your computer from a remote location). To resolve this issue, edit your phone book entry to use the same protocol the RAS Server is using: in Control Panel, double-click "Network Connections". Right-click on the icon for your ISP's connection and select Properties. Select the Networking tab, and ensure you have the "Type of dial-up server" set to "PPP: Windows 95/98/NT4/2000, Internet". If you do not have this option, select the one starting with "PPP:". Click OK at the bottom of the page and attempt the connection.

The Ways Of The Worm

Q I run Windows XP Pro. My system has become very slow, and I suspect it's infected by a virus. I am not able to open the Registry Editor to disable startup programs. I have found that in my user profile folder under Local Settings\Application Data, a new folder called "Bron.tok-24" has been created. I know this is a virus, but how do I get rid of it?

Prakash Mallik

A Your system has been infected by W32.Rontokbro@mm, which is a worm. It can be removed by following these steps:



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

Disable System Restore.

Update your virus definitions.

Run a full system scan and delete all the files detected as infected.

Download and run Symantec's security response tool from <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/tool.to.reset.s.helloopencommand.registry.keys.html> to reset the changes made by the worm to the Registry. This will allow you to launch the Registry Editor.

Now, open the Registry Editor and go to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run, and delete the "Bron-Spizaetus" = "C:\WINDOWS\PIF\CVT.exe" value.

Next, go to Control Panel > Scheduled Tasks. Look for an offensive Task that has been created by the worm. To check, right-click a task icon and select properties. If the contents show something like "%UserProfile%\Templates\A.kotnorB.com", delete it!

Vista Or MCE?

Q Can I view TV channels after installing Windows XP Media Center Edition without a TV-Tuner card? Can Windows Vista also do that? Which of these two OSes is better for 3D games and graphics?

Rana Deep

A You'll always need a TV-Tuner for watching TV on your PC. Vista will ship with DirectX 10 and will be a better OS than Media Center Edition for 3D games and graphics. Microsoft lists rather modest minimum PC hardware requirements for Vista, which is a "modern processor" running at 800 MHz, 512 MB of RAM, and a DirectX 9 compatible graphics solution.

Die-X?

Q Whenever I view a DivX movie in full screen mode, it skips or hangs. The processor usage is shown as 100% at this time. What could be the problem? I have an AMD Athlon XP 1800+, GeForce FX 5200, and 512 MB of RAM.

Sabir S R

A Uninstall all the codecs you may have installed (including codec packs). Download and install the latest version of the DivX codec and player from www.divx.com. You should now have no problems running DivX movies. ■